

KNOW BEFORE YOU GO

Saint Barthélemy

A few practical notes for your week in St. Barths — currency, tipping, language, and the rest of the small things that make travel feel easy.

PASSPORT & ENTRY

Valid passport required

St. Barths is a French overseas collectivity. US citizens do not need a visa for stays under 90 days. Make sure your passport is valid for at least three months beyond your return date.

TIPPING

Service is typically included

Restaurants include service (*service compris*). An extra 5–10% for excellent service is appreciated but not expected. \$5–10 per service is gracious for drivers, beach attendants, and concierge.

TIME & WEATHER

AST · warm, dry, breezy in May

Atlantic Standard Time (UTC–4) — same as US Eastern in summer. Mid-May runs 78–85°F with low humidity and steady trade winds. Pack a light layer for evenings on the water.

CONNECTIVITY

US carriers cover the island

T-Mobile, AT&T, and Verizon all reach St. Barths — check your international plan before you leave. Wi-Fi is standard at Fouquet's and most restaurants.

CURRENCY & PAYMENTS

Euro is official; USD widely accepted

Most hotels, restaurants, and beach clubs take USD and major credit cards. Some smaller boutiques are euro-only. ATMs are available in Gustavia.

LANGUAGE

French, with English everywhere in tourism

French is the official language; English is widely spoken at hotels, restaurants, and beach clubs. A *bonjour* on arrival and *merci* on departure goes a long way.

POWER & PLUGS

220V · European Type C / E

Two-prong European outlets. Most modern phone and laptop chargers handle 220V automatically — check the fine print on the brick. Bring a Continental Europe adapter for anything single-voltage.

DRIVING THE MOKE

Right-hand traffic · narrow, winding roads

Your US driver's license is valid. Roads are steep, narrow, and scenic — drive slowly and confidently. The Moke is open-air; toss a light jacket and a hat in the back for windy stretches.